HYBRIDS · 5 MIN READ

Hybrid specs that change the ride

Two hybrids can look the same and be ₹40,000 apart. These are the parts that explain the gap.

Brakes

- **Mechanical disc**: worked by a cable. Cheaper, needs more hand effort and regular adjustment. Example: Trek FX 1 Disc.
- **Hydraulic disc**: worked by fluid. Light lever, strong braking, adjusts itself as pads wear. Example: Trek FX 3.

Fork

Entry hybrids have a steel or aluminium fork. Better ones, like the FX 3, have a **carbon fork**. It is lighter and takes road buzz out of the handlebar.

Drivetrain

- **3x** (three front rings): older style, many gears overlap.
- **2x**: wide range, common on entry and mid hybrids.
- **1x** (one front ring): one shifter, no front derailleur, less to go wrong. The FX 3 uses a 1×10 setup.

More gears does not mean more speed. What matters is the range from the easiest gear to the hardest. A 1×10 with a wide cassette covers nearly everything a city rider needs.

Frame

Almost every hybrid is aluminium. The exception in our range is the **Trek FX Sport**, which has a carbon frame and is Trek's fastest flat-bar bike.

Mounts and tyres

- Ask commuters about carrying a bag and riding in rain. Check the frame has rack and mudguard mounts.
- Tyres from 32 to 40 mm. Wider is more comfortable on broken roads.

With every hybrid

Helmet, front and rear lights, a lock, bottle cage, floor pump, and mudguards before monsoon. Offer them at the time of sale, not later.

Remember these

- Hydraulic discs: lighter lever, stronger, self-adjusting.
- Carbon fork: lighter and smoother at the handlebar.
- 1x means one front ring and one shifter. Gear range matters more than gear count.
- FX Sport is the carbon-frame hybrid.